

Interview pipeline

- Recruiter: role fit, logistics, communication and truthful status.
- Assessment: solve, validate and document.
- Technical: Excel/SQL/Power BI/Python/statistics reasoning.
- Hiring manager: business judgment, project ownership, trade-offs and communication.
- Final/panel: consistency, collaboration, questions, logistics and offer discussion.

Practice rule

Answer once without notes -> mark the weakest reasoning/communication point -> review only that concept -> answer a changed question -> save the fresh retry. Memorized scripts are not mastery.

60-second introduction + project walkthrough

- Intro: PRESENT -> PROOF -> TARGET. Present current truthful direction; proof through projects/core skills/validation habits; target why this role.
- Project: decision -> data/grain -> quality -> method -> validation -> 2-3 findings -> recommendation -> limitation.
- Be ready to open the repository/report and explain one failure/recovery.
- Do not narrate your whole life; do not call a course project employment.

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Technical interview method

- Start with definition/grain and clarify ambiguous denominator.
- State method before syntax. Solve the smallest correct version.
- Validate row counts, joins, duplicates/NULLs, totals/rates or boundary cases.
- Excel: lookups, SUMIFS/COUNTIFS, IF boundaries, Tables/Pivots/Power Query, reconciliation.
- SQL: WHERE/HAVING, joins/cardinality, CTEs/windows, NULL/date logic, grain validation.
- Power BI: star schema, relationships/filter flow, measures/CALCULATE/time, visuals, refresh/RLS.
- Python: inspect/clean, filter/groupby/merge validate, dates/reshape/EDA/reproducibility.
- Statistics: center/spread, sampling bias, SE/CI, p-values/effect size, correlation/causality, A/B design.

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Behavioral interview clinic

- STAR/CAR: keep Situation/Task short; spend most time on Action, validation, trade-off, communication and Result/learning.
- Fresher project/lab examples are valid if clearly labelled projects.
- If asked about conflict/leadership and you lack workplace example, use an honest academic/project/team example if relevant.
- Never invent a client, manager or production impact.

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Offers, salary, questions and error log

- Research the actual role/company/location before interview; ask the budgeted range if appropriate.
- If you state a range, use one you would genuinely accept/justify. Never invent another offer.
- Evaluate role scope, learning, location/relocation, compensation and conditions together.
- Prepare 2-4 interviewer questions about role success, data stack/process, team, expectations or next steps.
- After every mock/real interview: question -> your answer -> weakness -> correct concept -> fresh retry. Do not fix weakness by collecting more question lists.

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